Social Media Do's and Don'ts

for College Students

☑ DO's

#	Do This ☑	Why It Matters
1	**Keep your profile photo professional**	First impressions on LinkedIn and Instagram matter to recruiters and professors.
2	**Think before you post**	Ask yourself: Would I be comfortable if my professor or future employer saw this?
3	**Use privacy settings wisely**	Limit personal posts to trusted audiences; keep professional profiles public.
4	**Share academic achievements and projects**	Showcasing your work builds your digital reputation and attracts opportunities.
5	**Engage respectfully in online discussions**	Constructive, polite engagement reflects well on your character and critical thinking.
6	**Credit others' work properly**	Always tag or mention the original creator when sharing someone else's content.
7	**Keep your bios and information up to date**	Outdated profiles look unprofessional — update them as you grow.

✕ DON'Ts

#	Avoid This ✕	Why It Matters
1	**Don't post offensive, discriminatory, or controversial content**	Such posts can damage your reputation permanently and affect job or admission prospects.
2	**Don't share personal details publicly (phone number, address, ID)**	Oversharing exposes you to identity theft, scams, and safety risks.
3	**Don't engage in or ignore cyberbullying**	Participating in or staying silent about harassment has real consequences — report it.
4	**Don't plagiarise or share copyrighted content without permission**	This can lead to academic penalties or legal issues.
5	**Don't post impulsively when angry or upset**	Emotional posts are hard to take back and can harm relationships and your image.
6	**Don't accept friend/follow requests from strangers indiscriminately**	Unknown accounts may be fake profiles used for phishing or harassment.
7	**Don't badmouth institutions, professors, or classmates online**	Even vague complaints can be traced back to you and damage important relationships.

Quick Reminder

> *Your digital footprint is permanent. What you post today can be seen, screenshotted, and shared years from now. Build an online presence you'd be proud to show anyone — because eventually, someone important will see it.*